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Build 4: Optimal-Consciousness

Thus far in our exploration of consciousness we have traversed the Bhagavad Gita's Second Teaching of Philosophy, learning of Krishna and her ode: to understand and encourage the detachment of oneself from actions, thereby purifying one's will and desire. For Krishna, this is the means consciousness or inner peace is eventually reached. Supported by Larmorian philosophy which sermonizes the concept of discontinuity, we draw connections between Krishna and narration. Defined as "the act of coordinating successive states into a sequence with design that gives purpose and enhances social coordination between individuals", through narration its plausible to argue that it is reason and awareness that disposes the self and their states to flow in synchrony, changing life courses according to respective will and desire.

However, analyzing Krishna through the lens of Larmor's discontinuity and narration prompts an onset of open-ended questions with no addressed answers. If Krishna claims the only means of meeting consciousness and thereby being content is by detaching to everything, that puts the conciseness of many under review. Is this to say Jesus was not conscious because of his attachment to redeeming the flawed human race? Within this question lies a focus on the importance of self and identity of self. Taking a closer look at the arguments found in philosophy written by Milton in his 'Paradise Lost', this build will use his view of self-conciseness as a lens to draw some plausible and sensible answers and will inspire the concept of 'optimal-consciousness'.

Milton's 'Paradise Lost' a retelling of the biblical origin of humans: the story of Eve and Adam. In his story, Milton portrays the subjective nature of consciousness and questions the context of freedom. The poem operates around three central characters. The first two, obviously, being Eve and her husband Adam. The third is Serpent. Because of the limits on Western society, Eve is often depicted as inherently weak. Easily susceptible to the serpents' tricks taking Adam's fate down along with her own. Milton take is far different. Throughout the poem, we witness dependency—not from Eve, but from Adam. When God created Adam, He created him alone. This is Adam's first experience of humanity; he is born and met with solitude. Thus, when God blesses him with company through Eve, he grew an attachment to her. An attachment to their relationship: a newfound existence to Adam which represents the absence of loneliness. Eve, born into companionship, instinctually seeks more. She wishes to explore which prompts Adam's biggest fear: her leaving him to tend to his silence. Here we see why Krishna is so stern on detachment: because attachment can easily become sour. In his attempts to keep her close, Adam leads Eve to believe she cannot live without him, cannot survive. This is where Eve, ambitious and operating with intention to prove herself, and Serpent's pathways cross. The Serpent serves as a depiction of narcissism. He is a soul stuck in a frozen idea of himself, inhibiting a next state of self. A state where he is different, better. He is trapped in his feud with God, swallowing his own key that unlocks the door to freedom, choosing to remain present in his thoughts of revenge. Living to spite God becomes his existence. He lures Eve, tempts her, and makes both she and Adam the original sinners. However, taking a comparative look at Eve and Serpent shows the difference Larmorian philosophy intends to emphasize. Eve and Serpent both disobey God and are rejected from paradise. They both sin, distorting the content of the reality in which they lived. Eve and her husband: banished from Eden, Serpent: banished from Heaven. They are both attached: Eve to Adam and Serpent to the downfall of God. The key feature that

differentiates them is their choice in how they define their next chapter. Their next state of self. Serpent allows his same hatred to drive his current state of self, which results in an endless loop of the same battered state. As opposed to Eve, who leaves Eden with Adam head facing forward. Accepting their wrongdoing in Eden and going forth to create happiness in the world as they wander, together. As an attached and coworking unit. Together they define and create their own happiness. They live together in consciousness. The key here is moving on and continuing to experience reality. Because reality is the present and what one makes of the now.

A great way to think of this concept of reality being what one makes of the present is taking a deeper look at the Serpent. Forbidden from Heaven, driven crazy in his quest to outshine God, he is banished to Hell. Destined to live forever in the fiery pits among sinners. But when Serpent enters hell, what welcomes him? Hundreds of fallen angles who await hungrily for his his return. Prepared to praise him, denounce God alongside him, feed into his narcissistic ego. What then? The Serpent will, in some way, have found what he had been searching for all along. Something similar to what Adam mourned over: companionship, just in a slightly more sadistic form. John Milton once wrote “The mind is its own place and, in itself can make a heaven of hell or a hell of heaven”. This is a great reflection the nature of reality in relation to human minds. It emphasizes that reality is subjective within the mind and is primarily what the person makes of their given situation. Consider everyday college students. In a single class, there is often Type A and Type B. The former being the student who finds time to see friends and have a personal life even when midterm assignments are at their worst. The latter, the student who can’t manage to find a semblance of free time because ‘they have so much to do’ and ‘school is too hard!!’. Of course, factors such IQ level and such serves as a reason for the dissonance between these two students, but what’s noticeable is student Type B is likely to complain more about the action of doing work than doing the action of work. It’s also notable that schoolwork’s tumultuous nature is a constant for humans. This person (Type B) has successfully completed dauting assignments countless times in the past to be considered a fit candidate for collegiate study. Moreover, person Type A likely has a more than generous workload as well. But they might take the initiative to schedule time for fun on particular weeks with lighter loads or suffer blissfully one Thursday to ensure a Friday of free time. Their intentional action to promote a better sense of wellbeing during the school year can very well change what was once a hell into something less hellish, and more like heaven. The possible source for Type B’s suffering might be their lack of disciplined actions and failure to take initiative in their own present to ameliorate their state of being. Here, it is school that can be made a heaven or hell, the thing that defines it is how the student thinks of it. The will behind the person’s actions and thoughts, and their desire to take initiative to change their own course.

There is one last unpondered question. If by Gita’s standards, consciousness is reached through unattachment, how then do Eve and Adam go on to experience it, deriving Milton’s claim that defining one’s personal identify is that through attachment one can find peace? The original sinners defined their personal identities within each other. This calls for several questions on the freedom of consciousness. Does it come about from attachment or unattachment? My take would be that Gita preaches a way to attain optimal consciousness. A life in which one experience reality as it comes, not shaping it to fit their needs or depending on other to help and accompany them in their journey through. Why? For just that reason, life isn’t a journey. Life is the present, the now. By way of unattachment, one eternally frees themselves form any master-servant relation they might come by. Any greedy or gluttonous persuasions. They do not depend on others’ perceptions of them. They successfully quite the worst parts of their ego. This isn’t to say they cannot become attached and still experience consciousness, it just eliminates the problems of personal identity. Placating the ego so the person never has to choose between being Eve or Serpent. Taking the

good path or the spiteful one. They can simply be. And once one starts to simply be, maybe their thoughts, their present will transform from human and self-centered, into thoughts that seriously analyze the world around us, outside of ourselves and our conception of that self.

Analogy—Western obsession with the future

P2

In Hagel's 'Phenomenality of Spirituality' were met with a tool that will help us traverse these suspicions of consciousness' origins and nature: the self-conscious. Hagel breaks down the self as

Oppositional argumentation—time being in the present/ money

P3

Draw arguments from 3 authors to make a story

Conclusion Paragraph

Debrief of what we coved and why claims flow

Ask open ended questions